

Section II

Word Processing Software

(Microsoft Word / Google Docs / LibreOffice Writer)

Lecture 1: Introduction to Word Processing and its Features

1. Introduction to Word Processing and Its Features

• DEFINITION — Word Processing

Using a computer and special application software to type, edit, format, save, and print text documents such as letters, reports, and assignments. The software used for this purpose is called **Word Processing Software** — e.g. **Microsoft Word**, **Google Docs**, and **LibreOffice Writer**.

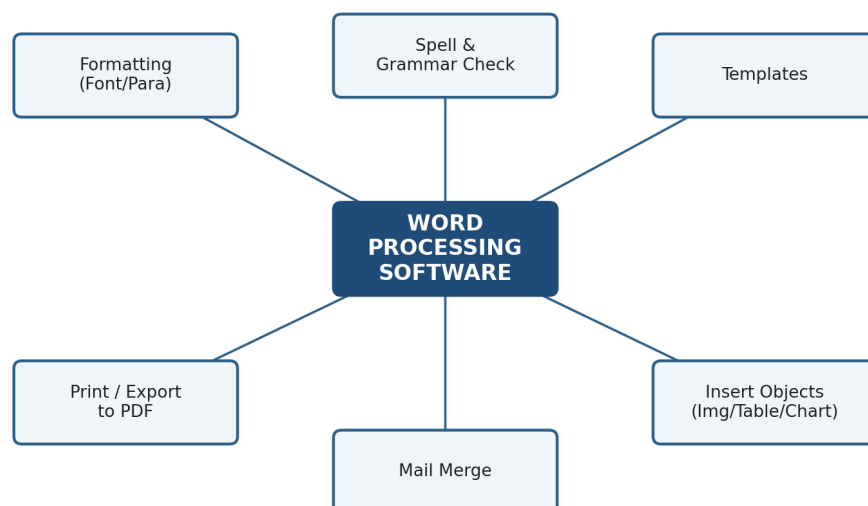
Word processing is the use of computer software to create, edit, format, save, and print text-based documents. The software used for this purpose is called a word processor.

Word processors are commonly used for preparing letters, applications, reports, resumes, assignments, notices, books, and other documents.

Examples of word-processing software: Microsoft Word, LibreOffice Writer, Google Docs, and Apple Pages.

Features of Word Processing

Key Features of Word Processing Software



1. **Creating Documents:**

A word processor allows users to create new documents and enter text using a keyboard.

2. **WYSIWYG (What You See Is What You Get):** The document appears on screen exactly as it will look when printed, letting the user check the appearance before wasting paper.

3. **Editing Text:**

Text can easily be inserted, deleted, copied, cut, pasted, and moved from one place to another.

4. **Text Formatting:**

The appearance of text can be changed using options such as:

- Font type
- Font size
- Bold, Italic and Underline
- Text colour
- Alignment

5. **Paragraph Formatting:**

Users can change line spacing, paragraph spacing, indentation, alignment, bullets, and numbering.

6. **Spell and Grammar Checking:**

Modern word processors can identify many spelling and grammatical errors and suggest corrections.

7. **Find and Replace:**

The Find feature searches for a particular word or phrase, while Replace can substitute it with another word or phrase.

8. **Inserting Objects:**

Users can insert various objects into a document, such as pictures, tables, shapes, charts, symbols, and hyperlinks.

9. **Page Formatting:**

The appearance of a page can be changed by setting margins, page size, orientation, columns, headers, and footers.

10. **Saving and Opening Documents:**

Documents can be saved for future use and opened again whenever required.

11. **Printing:**

Word processors provide options to preview and print documents and select settings such as page range and number of copies.

12. **Copy, Cut and Paste:**

These features make editing faster:

- Ctrl + C – Copy
- Ctrl + X – Cut
- Ctrl + V – Paste

13. Undo and Redo:

Undo reverses the previous action, while Redo restores an action that was undone.

14. Mail Merge:

Mail Merge is used to create multiple personalized documents, such as letters, certificates, labels, or invitations, using a common template and a list of recipients.

Advantages of Word Processing

- Documents can be created quickly.
- Editing and correcting mistakes is easy.
- Documents can be professionally formatted.
- The same document can be reused and modified.
- Images, tables, and other objects can be added.
- Documents can be stored, shared, and printed easily.
- It saves time compared with manual typing and rewriting.

Examples of Word Processing Software

Software	Developer/Provider
Microsoft Word	Microsoft
Google Docs	Google
LibreOffice Writer	The Document Foundation
Apple Pages	Apple

2. Creating, Saving, and Opening Documents

• DEFINITION — Creating / Saving / Opening

The three basic file-handling actions in any word processor — starting a fresh document, storing it permanently on disk/cloud, and loading a previously stored document back onto the screen.

Creating a New Document

Every piece of work in a word processor begins with a new document — either a completely blank page, or a page based on a ready-made template.

1. Open the word processing software (MS Word / Google Docs / LibreOffice Writer).

2. Click on the **File** menu, then choose **New**.
 3. Choose a **Blank Document** to type from scratch, or a **Template** (resume, letter, report) for a ready-made design.
 4. A new working window opens with a blinking cursor, ready for typing.
- Shortcut key: **Ctrl + N** is generally used to open a new blank document quickly, without going through the File menu.

Creating → Saving → Opening a Document

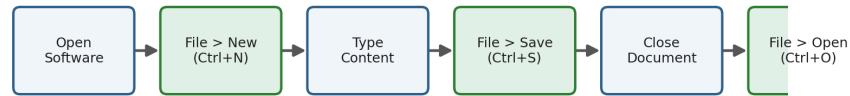


Fig 2.1 — The Create → Save → Open cycle of a document

Saving a Document

- Saving stores the document permanently — on the computer's hard disk, a pen drive, or cloud storage (Google Drive/OneDrive) — so it is not lost when the software or computer is closed.
- **Save:** File > Save (or **Ctrl + S**). If saving for the first time, a dialog box asks for file name, location, and file format.
- **Save As:** Keeps the original file unchanged and creates a fresh copy under a new name, location, or file format — e.g., saving a .docx letter as a .pdf for sharing.
- **File Formats:** **.docx** (Word), **.odt** (LibreOffice), **.pdf** (fixed, non-editable), **.rtf**, or plain **.txt**.
- **Auto-Save (Google Docs):** Since Google Docs runs in the browser, it automatically and continuously saves every change to Google Drive, so there is usually no need to press Save at all.

Opening an Existing Document

5. Click **File**, then choose **Open**.
 6. Browse folders/drives for the file, or pick it from the **Recent Documents** list.
 7. Click the file name and press **Open**.
- Shortcut key: **Ctrl + O** opens a saved document quickly. In Google Docs, a saved file can also be opened directly from Google Drive on any internet-connected device.

3. Formatting Text: Font, Paragraph, Styles, Page Layout

● DEFINITION — Formatting

Formatting is the process of changing the **appearance and arrangement of text and pages** in a document. It helps to make a document **clear, attractive, organized, and professional**.

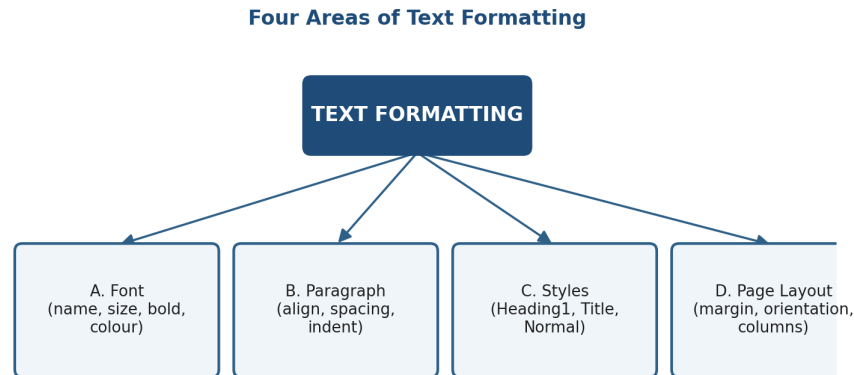


Fig 3.1 — The four areas of text formatting

The main areas of formatting in a word processor are:

1. **Font Formatting**
2. **Paragraph Formatting**
3. **Styles**
4. **Page Layout**

A. Font Formatting

Font formatting refers to changing the appearance of **individual characters, words, or selected text**.

The main font-formatting options are:

1. **Font Name:**
It changes the design or typeface of the text.
Examples: **Arial**, **Calibri**, **Times New Roman**.
2. **Font Size:**
It changes the size of the text. Font size is generally measured in **points (pt)**. For example, body text may use 11–12 pt, while headings may use a larger size.
3. **Font Style:**
Different styles can be applied to emphasize text:
 - **Bold** – makes text darker and thicker.
 - *Italic* – makes text slanted.

- **<u>Underline</u>** – places a line below the text.
- 4. **Font Colour:**
It is used to change the colour of selected text.
- 5. **Text Highlighting:**
It adds a background colour behind text, similar to using a highlighter pen.
- 6. **Special Text Effects:**
A word processor provides effects such as:
 - **Superscript:** Places text above the normal line, e.g., x^2 .
 - **Subscript:** Places text below the normal line, e.g., H_2O .
 - **Strikethrough:** Draws a line through the text.
 - **Change Case:** Changes text to UPPERCASE, lowercase, Title Case, etc.

B. Paragraph Formatting

Paragraph formatting refers to changing the **position and arrangement of an entire paragraph** on a page.

The main paragraph-formatting options are:

1. **Alignment:**
Alignment determines the position of text between the margins. Four common types are:
 - **Left Alignment:** Text is aligned with the left margin.
 - **Right Alignment:** Text is aligned with the right margin.
 - **Centre Alignment:** Text is placed in the centre.
 - **Justified Alignment:** Text is adjusted so that both left and right edges appear even.
2. **Line Spacing:**
It determines the amount of vertical space **between lines of text** within a paragraph. Common options include **single, 1.5 and double spacing**.
3. **Paragraph Spacing:**
It controls the space **before or after a paragraph**. It helps separate different paragraphs without repeatedly pressing the Enter key.
4. **Indentation:**
Indentation moves text inward from the margins. Common types include:
 - **–First Line:** Controls the left boundary for the first line of a paragraph
 - **– Hanging:** Controls the left boundary of every line in a paragraph except the first one
 - **– Left:** Controls the left boundary for every line in a paragraph
 - **– Right:** Controls the right boundary for every line in a paragraph
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5. **Bullets and Numbering:**
Bullets and numbering are used to organize information into a clear list.

For example:

- Keyboard

- Mouse
- Monitor
- Printer

Or:

1. Input
2. Processing
3. Output

C. Styles

A **Style** is a predefined combination of **font and paragraph formatting settings** that can be applied to text with a single command.

Common built-in styles include:

- **Title**
- **Heading 1**
- **Heading 2**
- **Normal**

Advantages of Styles

- They maintain **consistent formatting** throughout the document.
- They save time because several formatting options can be applied together.
- Heading styles can be used to automatically create a **Table of Contents**.
- Users can also create and save **custom styles**.

For example, instead of manually making every heading **16 pt, bold and blue**, a user can create or apply a heading style.

D. Page Layout

Page Layout refers to the arrangement and appearance of the **entire page** of a document.

Important page-layout options include:

1. **Margins:**
Margins are the **blank spaces between the text and the edges of the page**. They can be set for the top, bottom, left, and right sides.
2. **Orientation:**
Orientation determines the direction in which the page is displayed or printed. There are two main types:
 - **Portrait:** Page is taller than it is wide.

- **Landscape:** Page is wider than it is tall.
- 3. **Paper Size:**
It determines the physical size of the page. Common sizes include **A4 and Letter**.
- 4. **Columns:**
Columns divide the page into **two or more vertical sections**. They are commonly used in newspapers, magazines, and newsletters.
- 5. **Page Break:**
A page break is used to **end the current page and start the following text on a new page**.
- 6. **Page Colour:**
It allows the user to change the background colour of the page.
- 7. **Page Borders:**
Page borders add lines or decorative borders around the page.

Difference Between Font, Paragraph, Styles and Page Layout

Formatting	Controls	Examples
Font	Appearance of characters	Font size, Bold, Italic, Colour
Paragraph	Arrangement of paragraphs	Alignment, Spacing, Indentation
Styles	Predefined formatting combinations	Heading 1, Heading 2, Normal
Page Layout	Appearance/arrangement of page	Margins, Orientation, Size, Columns